Socratic Prompting

Make the AI reason first, then generate.

USE IT WHEN The stakes are high: policies, proposals, process documents, and plans where quality really matters.

THE THREE PHASES

1 Theoretical

"What makes a high-quality version of this output?"

The AI defines purpose, what separates average from exceptional, and common mistakes.

2 Framework

"What principles and structures apply here?"

The AI surfaces established frameworks, structure, sequencing, and success measures.

3 Application

"Now apply all of that to my specific task."

Only after the first two phases does the AI produce the final output.

COPY AND FILL IN

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Before you write anything, work through three phases.

PHASE 1: What makes an excellent [type of output]? What separates average from
exceptional?
PHASE 2: What frameworks, structures, and principles apply?
PHASE 3: Apply all of that to my task: [describe your task, audience, and
limits]
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Why it works

You get genuine expertise instead of pattern matching. The extra reasoning step costs seconds and routinely produces a noticeably stronger first draft.